



Identifying Language Features in Narratives

Name: _____

Date: _____

Class: _____

Read the text and highlight the language features.

How to use:

1. Read the narrative text carefully.
2. Highlight each language feature in a different colour.
3. Complete the table below by writing the example and explaining how it adds to the narrative.

Suggested Highlighter Key

-  Simile
-  Metaphor
-  Personification
-  Vivid Descriptive Language
-  Dialogue
-  Sentence Varieties (Short / Long)
-  Emotive Language



The Lost Map

Maya pushed open the creaky gate and stepped into the overgrown garden. The air was thick with the scent of jasmine, and the sun filtered through the leaves *like gold dust*.

"This is it," she whispered, clutching the old map her grandfather had given her. It was wrinkled and torn, but the faded ink promised adventure.

As she followed the winding path, the trees *seemed to lean in*, guarding their secrets. A robin sang cheerfully, as if to guide her. Suddenly, the ground dipped, and there it was—a hidden stone stairway, *swallowed by ivy*.

Maya's heart raced. Would this really lead to the treasure her grandfather had spoken of? Taking a deep breath, she began to descend, each step *echoing like a question* in the quiet.

"Courage," she told herself, "is not the absence of fear, but the decision to keep going."

And so, with courage as her compass, Maya disappeared into the darkness below.

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Great writers choose their words carefully. You be a language detective! 





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The Midnight Adventure

Lily had always been curious. So when she found a tiny, silver key on the floor of her grandmother's attic, her heart skipped with excitement. The key was cold and heavy in her palm, glinting like a sliver of moonlight.

At the far end of the attic stood a small, locked door. It hadn't been there before—or had it? Taking a deep breath, Lily turned the key. The door creaked open, and a rush of dust and memories swirled around her like forgotten whispers.

Inside was a room unlike any she had ever seen. The shelves were packed with curious treasures: maps with secret markings, jars filled with sea glass, and a telescope pointed at the stars. An old journal lay open on a desk.

"Grandma?" Lily called softly.

"I knew you'd find it one day," came a gentle voice from behind her. Grandma smiled. "Some adventures are written for the brave."

Lily felt a thrill of courage rise within her. This wasn't just an attic—it was the beginning of her own story.

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The Storm on Lighthouse Point

The wind howled like a wild animal as dark clouds rolled across the sky. Mia pulled her jacket tighter and hugged her knees, watching the waves crash against the jagged rocks far below.

“Are you sure we should be up here?” Liam shouted over the roar.

Mia didn’t answer. She couldn’t take her eyes off the lighthouse. Its light flickered, then went dark. For a long moment, everything was still—except the storm.

Then, with a groan, the door at the base of the lighthouse creaked open.

A silhouette stepped out, tall and thin, wrapped in a long, battered coat.

“We didn’t think anyone lived here,” Mia said, her voice barely above the wind.

The stranger smiled, his eyes twinkling like stars between the raindrops.

“Not many people do,” he replied. “But this light has been guiding ships safely for over a hundred years.” He looked at the storm. “And tonight, it needs a little help.”

Mia and Liam exchanged a glance. Without a word, they followed him inside, ready for whatever adventure the night would bring.



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Spotting language features helps us understand how stories come alive!





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The Secret Note

Eli slipped out of bed and crept across the floor. The house was silent, but outside, the wind howled like a lonely wolf.

He had found the note in the attic, tucked behind an old box of photographs. The paper was yellowed, its edges curled like autumn leaves.

The note was from his grandfather, written the night before he left on his final adventure.

“If you’re reading this,” it said, “it means you’re brave enough to chase your own stories.”

Eli’s heart thudded. What adventure could a twelve-year-old have? He had never been beyond the neighbourhood creek.

But as he stepped outside, the sky was a deep, sparkling blue, and something inside him shifted. Maybe stories didn’t just happen on the page.

Maybe they were waiting—for him.

He took a deep breath, tucked the note safely into his pocket, and set off down the path.

Somewhere ahead, a new story was beginning.

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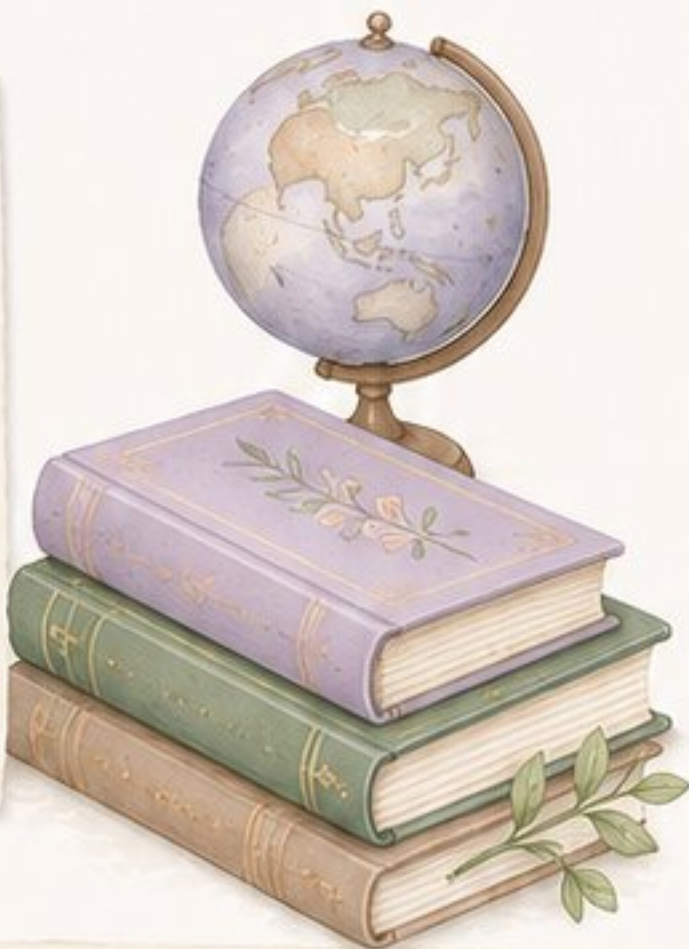
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The Crossing

The ferry sliced through the water like a knife, leaving a silver trail that shimmered in the morning sun. Mia clutched her backpack tighter as the wind howled across the deck, tugging at her hair and coat. Today was the day she would finally see the island—an old, forgotten place that had been spoken about in family stories for generations.

The island rose out of the mist like a sleeping giant, its cliffs steep and rugged, covered in dark green trees that seemed to whisper secrets.

“Almost there,” called the captain, his voice warm but steady over the roar of the engine.

Mia’s heart pounded. She had never been so far from home. The thought of exploring the ruins, the caves, the hidden beach—everything—made her feel both excited and afraid.

The ferry slowed, and the ramp lowered with a groan. As Mia stepped onto the island, she took a deep breath and smiled.

Adventure, she thought, begins now.

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The Unexpected Visitor

It was an ordinary Saturday afternoon—sunshine, birdsong, and the smell of freshly baked cookies drifting from the kitchen.

Jade was curled up on the couch, lost in her book, when a soft tapping came at the window. She sighed. “Probably that cheeky magpie again,” she muttered.

But when she looked up, her breath caught.

Standing on the sill was a tiny, scruffy kitten, its fur the colour of storm clouds and its eyes bright as amber.

“Well, hello there,” Jade whispered, opening the window a crack.

The kitten didn’t jump in right away. Instead, it tilted its head, as if asking a question only she could hear. Then, with the grace of a shadow, it stepped inside.

From that day on, nothing was ordinary. The kitten—who Jade named Nimbus—followed her everywhere, turning quiet afternoons into adventures. They explored hidden paths, chased butterflies, and watched the stars together from the rooftop.

Jade realised that sometimes, the best stories don’t come from books. Sometimes, they come with whiskers.



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The Forgotten Key

As the rain hammered against the old library windows, Noah wandered down the creaky aisle of books. The library smelled of dust and stories, a scent as old as time itself.

He ran a finger along the spines until something glinted on the floor behind a loose bookshelf. A tiny key. It was brass, cold, and covered in curious symbols.

His heart thumped with excitement. What could it unlock?

Noah slipped the key into his pocket and decided to ask Mrs. Linton, the librarian.

She peered over her glasses. “Ah,” she said with a knowing smile, “you’ve found one of the library’s secrets.”

Together, they followed a narrow hallway Noah had never noticed before. At the end was a small door, no bigger than a cupboard. Mrs. Linton knelt and turned the key.

The lock clicked, and the door swung open.

Inside was a room filled with wonders—maps that shimmered like jewels, a globe that glowed softly, and journals tied with ribbon.

“These are the stories people never finished,” she whispered. “Now it’s your turn to keep them alive.”

Noah smiled. Some keys don’t just open doors—they open adventures.



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The Lost Map

Maya loved nothing more than exploring. Forests, beaches, old ruins—if it looked like an adventure, she was already halfway there.

So when she found the crumpled map in the drawer of her grandfather’s desk, her heart leapt. The paper was brittle and stained with tea, covered in strange markings and a single sentence at the bottom: “The greatest treasures are the ones you earn.”

Maya’s eyes shone. “This is real,” she whispered.

She packed her bag, grabbed a torch, and set off before the sun had climbed over the hills.

The path wound through thick bush where the trees stood like ancient giants, their leaves whispering secrets only the wind could understand.

After hours of climbing, slipping, and splashing through icy streams, she reached a hidden cove. The map had led her here.

Tucked beneath a flat rock was a small wooden chest. Her hands trembled as she opened it.

Inside wasn’t gold or jewels, but a journal.

On the first page, her grandfather’s writing filled the lines.

“The real treasure isn’t something you keep,” he had written. “It’s every challenge you face, every place you discover, and every person you help along the way.”

Maya smiled, feeling richer than she ever had before.

She looked out at the endless ocean, sunlight sparkling like a million tiny stars on the waves. The adventure, she realised, had only just begun.



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The Midnight Bakery

Every night at midnight, when the town was fast asleep and the stars sprinkled the sky like sugar, a small bakery came to life.

Lily had always thought the old bakery at the end of her street was just a dusty, closed-up shop. But one night, drawn by the smell of warm vanilla and something magical, she tiptoed closer. The sign above the door creaked open by itself.

Inside, the lights glowed softly, and tiny sparks of flour danced in the air.

A whisk, taller than her, waved like a conductor. Cupboards hummed.

“Welcome, Lily,” said a voice like honey.

Lily gasped. A cat with fur the colour of cinnamon was kneading dough on the counter.

“I’m Crumble,” he purred. “We bake memories here.”

“Memories?” Lily whispered.

“Every cookie holds one,” he said, sprinkling in laughter and a pinch of courage.

Together, they baked cookies for lost things—a button, a toy, a note.

Each one shimmered with stories.

When the clock chimed one, the bakery grew quiet again.

Crumble handed her a small box. “For when you need to remember,” he said.

Lily stepped back into the night.

In her pocket were three cookies—and the best secret she’d ever known.



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The Midnight Treehouse

Oliver had always believed the old gum tree in his backyard was special. Its trunk was thick and knotted like a giant’s hands, and its branches stretched wide, protecting the yard like a leafy umbrella.

One stormy night, when the rain drummed on the roof and the wind howled through the streets, Oliver heard a creak. Then another. Curious, he tiptoed outside with his torch.

High among the branches, hidden by leaves, was a treehouse he had never seen before.

A rope ladder swayed gently in the wind, like an invitation.

Heart pounding, Oliver climbed up.

Inside, a tiny lantern glowed, casting golden light over cushions, maps, and shelves filled with books.

On the wall was a note: “For dreamers and adventurers. Make this place your story.”

Oliver grinned. This wasn’t just a treehouse—it was a secret kingdom.

That night, as the storm raged outside, he opened a notebook and began to write.

By the time the sun rose, the rain had stopped, but Oliver’s adventure was only just beginning.



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The Carnival Surprise

The carnival lights shimmered like a galaxy spilled across the town square. Music bounced through the air, and the smell of popcorn and fairy floss wrapped around Mia like a warm hug.

She clutched her ticket, her heart thumping with excitement. Tonight was the final night of the carnival, and the Ferris wheel—the one that touched the clouds—was calling her name.

When she reached the front of the line, the sky rumbled. A storm was rolling in.

“Should we go?” her friend Jake asked, glancing up at the darkening clouds.

Mia grinned. “Just one ride. Then we’ll run if it gets too bad!”

They climbed into the gondola. As the wheel began to turn, the town below shrank to a patchwork of lights.

Wind tangled Mia’s hair, whipping it across her face like a playful kitten.

Halfway to the top, the power flickered—and the carnival went silent.

You could hear the wind. You could hear the rain beginning to drum.

Then, right at the very top, the lights came back on.

All of them.

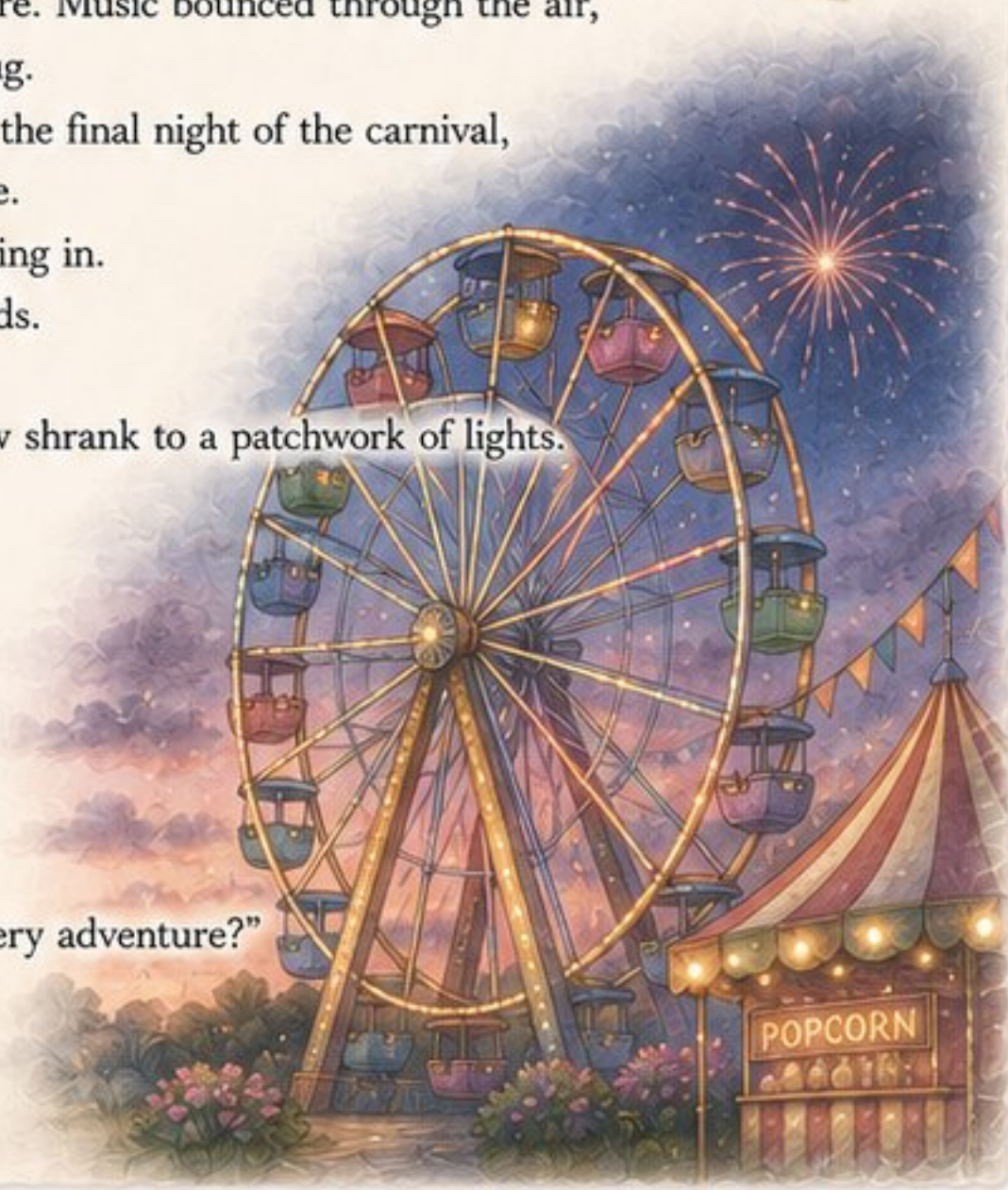
Fireworks exploded over the lake, painting the sky in gold and violet.

Jake pulled a small box from his pocket and held it out.

“Mia,” he said, his voice shaking slightly, “will you be my partner—on every adventure?”

Mia’s eyes filled with tears. “Yes,” she whispered, “yes!”

The Ferris wheel kept turning, carrying them higher and higher, as the storm passed and a new kind of adventure began.



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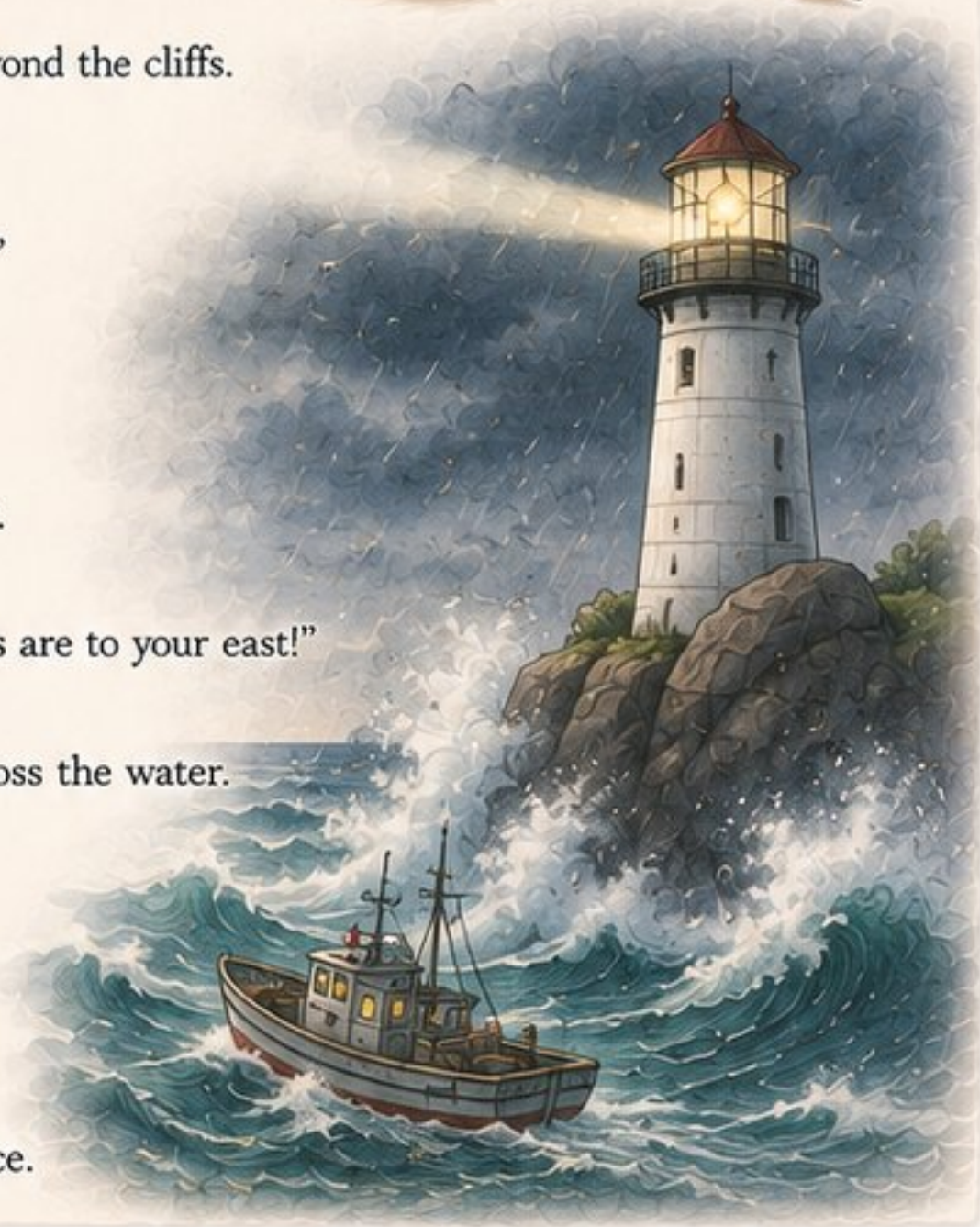
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The Storm and the Lighthouse

The wind had been building all afternoon, growling like a hungry beast beyond the cliffs. By evening, the sea was no longer waves—it was a wild, foaming maze. Inside the lighthouse, Tom tightened the lantern and checked the radio. “Another one coming through,” the radio crackled. “Stay safe out there.” Tom looked out the window. Rain lashed against the glass in icy sheets, and the ocean below was a churning blanket of silver and black. Yet the lighthouse stood tall, a brave sentry against the chaos. Then he saw it—a tiny fishing boat, tossed like a leaf in a flooded gutter. The bow rose and fell, rose and fell. Tom’s heart clenched. He grabbed the megaphone. “This is the lighthouse! Head north! The rocks are to your east!” No reply. Just the scream of wind and the crash of waves. Tom didn’t hesitate. He turned the beam to its brightest and swept it across the water. The light cut through the darkness like a sword through fog. Slowly, the boat turned. Inch by inch, it followed the beam. Minutes later, it disappeared into the safer waters beyond the cove. Tom let out a breath he didn’t know he was holding. He leaned on the railing, watching the storm rage. Some nights, he thought, the smallest light can make the biggest difference.



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The Secret Garden

Lily had always thought the old garden at the back of her grandmother's house was just a tangle of weeds and shadows. But on the first morning of spring, something caught her eye.

Behind a crooked gate, half hidden by ivy, was a tiny path she had never noticed before.

"What's in here?" she whispered, pushing the gate open. It creaked loudly, as if it had been waiting for her.

The garden beyond was like a secret the world had forgotten. Roses climbed the walls, wisteria hung like purple curtains, and birds flitted from branch to branch, singing songs only for the morning.

Lily knelt down and brushed the dirt from a small stone bench. She sat, closed her eyes, and listened. The sunshine felt like a warm blanket, wrapping around her shoulders.

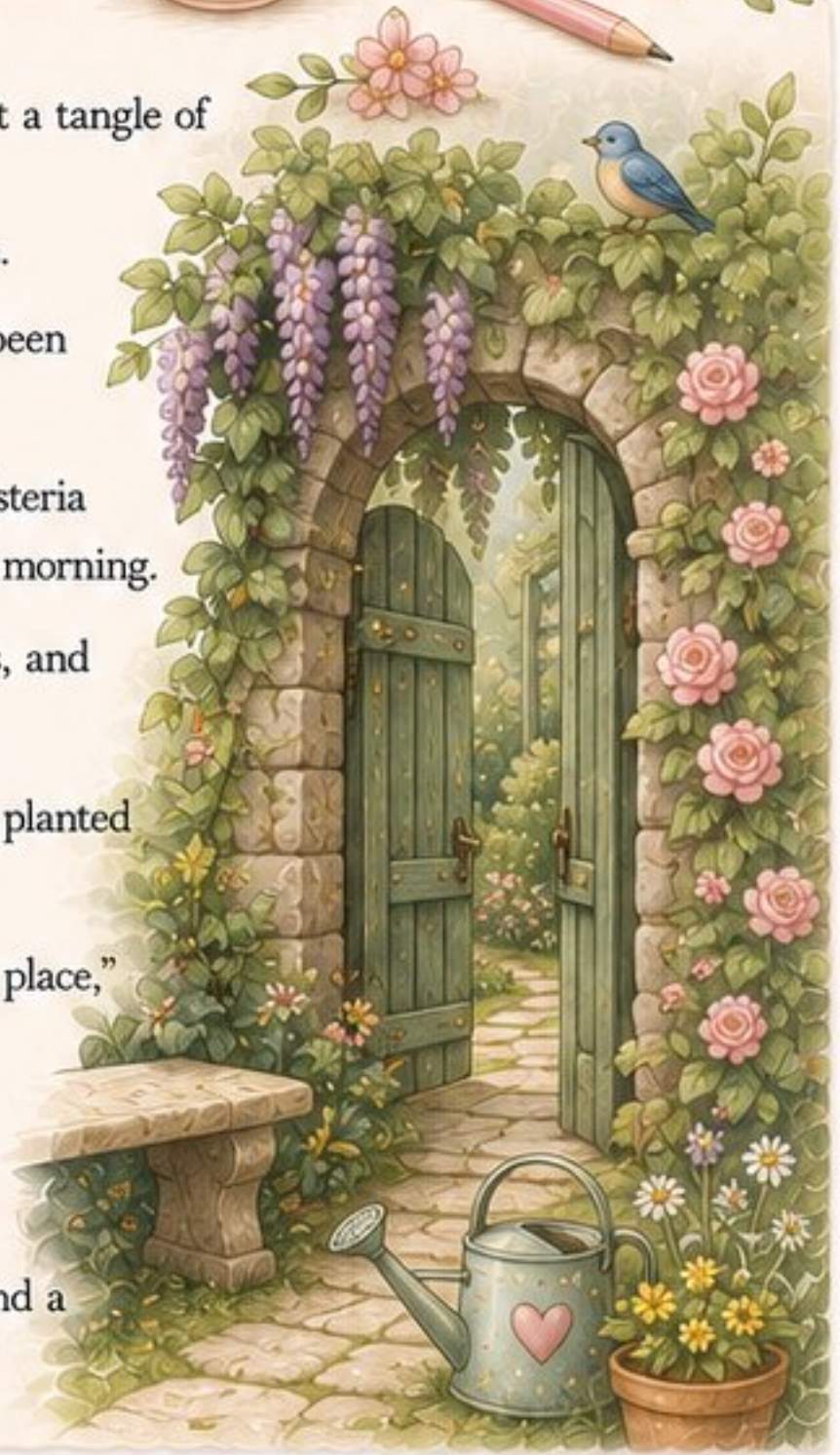
Day by day, Lily returned with gloves, a trowel, and a bucket of hope. She pulled weeds, planted seeds, and whispered encouragement as if the plants were old friends.

One afternoon, her grandmother appeared at the gate. "You've brought life back to this place," she said softly, her eyes shining. "I thought it was gone forever."

Lily grinned. "Some things just need a little love."

Together, they sat on the stone bench, watching the garden bloom in a hundred colours.

And Lily knew they had both found something precious that spring—a place to grow, and a heart that could heal.



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